Forklift Operator Training Manual

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1. Purpose

This manual sets out the mandatory training curriculum and competency requirements for employees seeking authorisation to operate powered industrial trucks (forklifts) at any Meridian Holdings Group site.

2. Prerequisites

2.1 Candidates must be at least eighteen years of age, hold a valid Company employee ID, and have completed the general Warehouse Health and Safety Induction before beginning forklift-specific training.

2.2 Candidates must pass a basic vision and physical fitness assessment administered by an approved occupational health provider.

3. Training Structure

3.1 Training consists of three stages: theoretical instruction (one full day), supervised practical operation (minimum sixteen hours across five working days), and a final competency assessment.

3.2 Theoretical instruction covers: forklift stability principles and the load centre concept, pre-operation inspection checklists, site-specific traffic rules, and relevant sections of the Workplace Health and Safety Manual (EN-MAN-01).

4. Pre-Operation Checks

4.1 Before each shift, operators must complete the Daily Forklift Inspection Checklist (Form HSE-FORM-05), covering tyre condition, hydraulic fluid levels, warning lights and horn function, seatbelt condition, and visible damage to the mast or forks.

4.2 Any defect identified during pre-operation checks must be reported immediately to the Warehouse Supervisor, and the vehicle must be tagged out of service until repaired.

5. Load Handling Principles

5.1 Operators must never exceed the rated load capacity indicated on the vehicle's data plate, and must account for reduced capacity when lifting loads at height.

5.2 Loads must be fully engaged on the forks and tilted back slightly for travel, with the forks kept as low as practicable — typically no more than 15 cm above ground level — while moving.

6. Assessment and Certification

6.1 Candidates must achieve a minimum score of 80% on the written theoretical assessment and a satisfactory rating on all items of the practical assessment checklist to be certified.

6.2 Certification is valid for three years, after which a refresher course and reassessment are required. Certification may be suspended immediately following any safety incident pending investigation.

7. Related Documents

- Workplace Health and Safety Manual (EN-MAN-01)
- Daily Forklift Inspection Checklist (HSE-FORM-05)

8. Approval

Approved by the Head of Health, Safety and Environment on 15 April 2026.